

themselves. Worms can cause harm just by overloading any network by moving from one node to another in huge numbers, thus causing legitimate traffic to be delayed or disrupted—though they can also carry malicious code.

5.2.9. Data Sniffers / Packet Sniffers

These are applications that try to detect the contents of a message you've sent. Any data that is transferred—e-mail, pictures, files—are split into data packets and then sent over the Internet. Any server through which the data packets pass can install a sniffer to detect the contents of the packet. Files that contain binary data like pictures or video can also be deciphered, but e-mail messages and other textual content show up as text in the sniffing application, making them easier to decipher. The encrypting of messages is the only way to prevent this from happening.